

The beginning of the 21st century witnessed the introduction of the iconic iPod. The device would soon go on to become a cult phenomenon and a generation-defining marvel of sorts, only to be eventually wiped away in the face of ever-changing technology.

Introduced in the early 2000s, the iPod – at its core a music player – acted as a conduit for teenagers to become a part of the coveted Apple ecosystem. If you look at the year 2001 when the iPod was first launched, the internet was on the cusp of massive proliferation and an entire generation was just emerging out of the Walkman phase.

The size of the Apple device was compact enough to fit into jeans pockets and neither did the introductory price burn a hole in the same. There are over a dozen devices in the entire line-up, both existing and discontinued. From Nano to Touch, the iPod has come a long way.

With the Cupertino, based company discontinuing the Nano and Shuffle variants in July this year, the challenge remains for the iPod Touch as it is currently the last warrior standing.

Here we delve into the this iconic device that defined an entire generation.

The iPod lineage

Beginning the streak, the iPod Classic was introduced in the year 2001, and Apple continued to introduce devices in the family each year, for the next 9 years. The latest update, if at all you want to call it that, came in 2015 with the iPod Touch 6th generation.

The iPod ecosystem is broadly divided into five segments – Classic, Nano, Shuffle, Mini and Touch. When the 1st Generation iPod Classic was introduced in 2001, it came with a scroll wheel and four buttons around it for smooth navigation.

The second generation of iPod Shuffle introduced in 2006, was smaller than the size of a matchbox and came with a clip that you could put on your shirt. This was the most compact of iPods and did not sport a screen.

The fifth generation iPod Nano, introduced in 2009, came with a camera unlike its predecessors. In 2005, iPod Nano replaced the iPod Mini, coming with the low-price tag.

Now the star player of the iPod line-up was the iPod Classic sixth generation which was introduced in 2007. With a storage space of 140 GB, the device could hold about 40,000 songs; it was also the last device to sport the click wheel.

If you were to determine the popularity of these variants by the number of models, iPod Nano and Classic remained the most popular categories.